

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Codenames

Passing off these names in a conversation will make you look like you're in on the inside information of some of the hottest products today!

Zephyr: The codename of the recently-released Xbox 360 Elite edition, the all-black Zephyr is an update over the Xbox 360, sporting an HDMI port and a hard disk bumped up to 120GB.

FASN8: The recently-announced Quad FX platform from AMD, the FASN8 (pronounced "fascinate") is the first AMD Silicon Next-gen 8-core platform from the company. It promises to put in eight physical cores of 2-Phenom FX processors on a single motherboard that supports HyperThreading.

F3: Sun's new open source product family, JavaFX, consists of JavaFX Script and JavaFX Mobile. This environment has the ability to run under any browser or operating system that supports Java. The reason it's so interesting is that JavaFX Script focuses on user experiences with interfaces that have rich animated media, while other scripting languages are more oriented towards building Web pages.

Bearlake: Intel's next-generation chipsets, the P35 supports 65 nm process nodes, the most advanced semiconductor fab technology. Due to this, the chipsets use lesser power and are more economical. The P35 chipsets will support DDR3 RAM, too.

Parivartan: A project by our Government to network towns and villages by making all vehicles function as free Wi-Fi nodes. The more the traffic, the faster the network becomes!

Usage: I love my *Zephyr*. Life will be rosy when I can browse the Net with *F3* on a *FASN8* or *Bearlake* system. Doing all that on the road sound too good to be true—let's pray that *Parivartan* takes off!

Wild Wild Web

Splat.. biff... poop!

Here's the end to your hair-ripping frustrations over stupid Web sites: horrible layouts, pesky ads, and all the other stuff that makes you go wild. Head to www.netdisaster.com, a fantastic place to vent your fury.

Here's how it works: enter the URL of a site you detest, and you'll immediately be able to crucify it visually. Spray-paint the page black. Call upon a dinosaur to stomp on it, fry eggs on it, and what-not from the "Disaster" options. Check out the "Massive" and "Self-repair" options—these allow massive damage to be done to the page, and repair the damage

you've already inflicted, respectively. Also use the sound effects for the ultimate site-disaster experience. And yes, don't miss out on the "Dirty disaster" options: make a cow drop dung or a dog poop on the page. Gross, but it's out there, and we thought we should let you know.

I/O

Microsoft has stooped to the level of putting up a spoof iPhone video on YouTube... believe it. But still, you've got to admit it's funny. At the MEDC 2007 (Mobile and Embedded DevCon), the company unveiled their new "iPhone killer" mobile phone video. The video went on

about a phone named "oFone": a circular display, three keypads, the facility to place keys anywhere you like, and a lot more.

Mel Sampat, who happens to be a program manager at Microsoft, claims that even "a four-year-old" can program APIs for the oFone. The thing has three separate keypads, so three people can game simultaneously. And when you get bored of that, it can act as a decent boomerang (it looks like one). Besides going about their serious business of making M-dollars, the folks at Microsoft do have a decent sense of humour. The iPhone spoof is at <http://tinyurl.com/2rhe59>.



three faces embedded in the hologram on new Vista DVDs. What's special about the photograph is that it's only a square millimetre in area, making it too small to see without magnification. The picture shows three guys standing together, smiling at the camera.

Following the announcement, conspiracy pundits immediately went into overdrive, proclaiming it an Easter egg. Some state they have inside information that Microsoft is running an internal enquiry regarding how the image got there, which meant that this wasn't known until now, and wasn't approved, and some heads are going to roll.

Unfortunately, all the

excitement was put to rest when Microsoft's Nick White posted about it on the Vista team's blog—"Conspiracy theorists will be disappointed, the photo is only one of multiple images contained in the hologram design, all of whose inclusion serves to make it more difficult to replicate a Windows Vista DVD."

The three lucky men in the photo, said White, are members of Microsoft's anti-piracy team who had worked on the holograms for the Vista OS. There are other images too in the hologram, some of them belonging to art masterpieces in the public domain, added White.

ENHANCED CHARITY

Surgeons Against Silicone

In the beginning was a Web site called MyFreeImplants.com, asking the fairer sex, "Have you ever wanted bigger breasts? But couldn't afford the expensive costs of

surgery? Here is your opportunity to earn Free Breast Implants!"—and enticing men with "Help the girl of YOUR dreams get the body of her dreams. Develop a connection with a girl of your choice and help her earn Free Breast Implants!"

Then, the British Association of Aesthetic Plastic Surgeons (BAAPS—if only they knew we'd be reading this in India) found out, and all hell broke loose.

The BAAPS states that the whole process of asking for donations for breast implants is demeaning, and takes away the important considerations and decisions that need to be taken into account before going in for the surgery. BAAPS president Douglas McGeorge says, "This is a wholly inappropriate way to proceed with what should be a serious decision made by a fully informed patient. The site's promise that there are 'no right or wrong' cases is frightening—clearly there is no proper medical assessment of candidates, which at best could lead to disappointment, at worst, to someone's health being endangered."